Sprint planning that actually holds.

Everything you need for your next planning session, on seven pages.

01 The capacity formula

02 Definition of Ready

03 The 60-minute agenda

04 Six copy-paste templates

05 Seven warning signs

Swipe to start

STEP 1 OF 4

Know your real capacity first.

01

Capacity = people × sprint days – leave – meetings

A **Then apply a focus factor**

Most teams deliver at 60 to 75% of raw capacity. Start at 70% and tune it with real data.

B **Commit to about 80% of that**

Leave room for the bug, the outage and the urgent request that will arrive anyway.

Example: 6 people × 10 days = 60 days. Minus 4 days of leave and 6 of meetings = 50. × 0.7 = about 35 days of real work.

STEP 2 OF 4

02

Definition of Ready: nothing enters the sprint without it.

- [ ] **Clear user and outcome**
  Who is it for, and what changes for them?
- [ ] **Acceptance criteria written**
  Testable, agreed with the product owner.
- [ ] **Sized by the team**
  Small enough to finish in a few days.
- [ ] **Dependencies named**
  Data, approvals, other teams. Owner and date for each.
- [ ] **Data and access in place**
  Nobody waits on a login on day three.
- [ ] **Fits the sprint goal**
  If it does not, it waits.

STEP 3 OF 4

The 60-minute planning agenda.

03

MINUTES	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO LEADS
0-5	Last sprint in one line: done, not done, why	Delivery manager
5-15	Product owner proposes the sprint goal	Product owner
15-25	Capacity check: leave, holidays, carry-over	Delivery manager
25-45	Team pulls ready items to the goal	Team
45-55	Risks, dependencies, first two days of work	Team
55-60	Read the goal aloud. Confidence vote 1 to 5	Everyone

TEMPLATES, PART 1

Copy these word for word.

SPRINT GOAL

By `date`, we will `outcome` so that `user` can `benefit`, and we will know it worked when `signal`.

USER STORY

As a `role`, I want `capability` so that `benefit`.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Given `context`, when `action`, then `result`.

Tip: pin the sprint goal at the top of the board and read it aloud at every stand-up.

TEMPLATES, PART 2

Three more you will use every week.

SAYING NO WITH A TRADE-OFF

We can take on `new request` this sprint if we move `item` to next sprint. Which matters more for `goal`?

BLOCKER ESCALATION

`Item` is blocked by `cause`. Impact: `days lost` and `goal at risk`. I need `decision or person` by `date`.

STAND-UP IN THREE QUESTIONS

What moved the `sprint goal` yesterday? What will move it today? What is in the way?

STEP 4 OF 4

04

Seven signs your sprint plan will break.

- **No single sprint goal**
  Just a list of tickets.
- **Over 100% of capacity committed**
  Hope is not a plan.
- **Stories bigger than half the sprint**
  Split them.
- **Carry-over above 20%**
  Two sprints in a row means planning is broken.
- **One person on the critical path**
  Pair or reassign.
- **Unowned dependencies**
  Another team, no date.
- **Nobody voted below 3**
  Silence is not confidence.

YOUR TURN

Which step does your team skip most?

Next in this series: the six delivery charts every agile delivery manager should read, and what each one is telling you.

01 Save it

so it is there at your next planning session.

02 Send it

to the delivery manager or Scrum Master who needs it.

03 Follow

for the next field guide in the series.